

FIRST PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH



BELLTOWER *February 2026*



From the Pastor

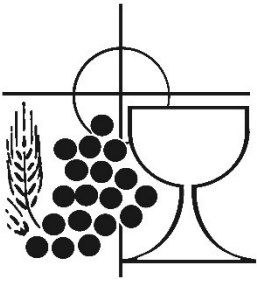
I turned the page from January to February on my calendar, and there in the middle of February is Ash Wednesday, which signals the beginning of Lent (the 40 days that lead up to Easter). The dates of Lent and Easter move around each year because it's based on the lunar calendar. This year it falls really early! I feel like we barely finished putting away the Christmas decorations!

Lent is the 40 days (not counting Sundays) that lead up to Easter, and it is set aside as a time of reflection to prepare for Easter. Some have used it for a time of fasting from something as they prepare. It could be meat, caffeine, sweets, television. I have heard all kinds of things that people have given up. I grew up with a tradition of adding extra devotional times, as a way to prepare our hearts.

Lent/Easter are significant times in the Church year, as such my hope is to help build a meaningful experience for our church family. We will be using materials from A Sanctified Art who created our Advent/Christmas materials. There will be devotionals to use during your own study time, worship and sermons that correspond along with the theme, and time for conversation after fellowship time. I hope you will participate as you are able, and it enhances your lent experience!

The title of the series is "Tell Me Something Good: Grounding Ourselves in the Good News this Lent". We will look at some of the core concepts of Jesus' life and ministry. These can bring us back to our roots, and ground us as a body of believers seeking to follow Christ's call.

Nikelle



At-Home Communion

If you are interested in having Nikelle and an Elder bring you communion at home, please let Nikelle know.

2025 Annual Report

Copies are now available at church. If you would like one mailed to you please contact the office.

Each Wednesday we join in prayer as a community.

We invite you to join us.

A Prayer for the Bleak Midwinter

This time of year, when every bough is bare
And every corner of the sky a deadened gray,
It's hard to find signs of life in the created world—
And maybe also in ourselves.

Long past the vibrant joy of Christmas,
Not yet arrived at the nourishment of Lent,
The world around us and the world within us
Can seem decidedly dormant. Stilled. Frozen over.

In these cold and darkened days,
Remind us that you gently cradle all seasons,
And let us see with fresh hope the new life
That is borne within dry branches.

Remind us that the ice will melt,
First in tiny rivulets, then in rushing streams—
That living water will yet flow.

Amen.

by Cameron Bellm



ANNOUNCEMENTS

Our Prayer Chain is now being handled by Susie Smith and Evelyn Thomas. You can contact Susie if you have a request to share and she will email the Prayer Chain. Evelyn will be Susie's backup. If you submit a request to the Prayer Chain it will be held in confidence with only those members and the pastor, until you share on Sunday morning or yourself. If you would like to be on the Prayer Chain let Susie or Evelyn know and you will be added. Thank you to all those who pray for the requests we receive.



MISSION WITNESS

Pop Tops

The Mission/Witness Committee is collecting tabs from the top of cans, including pop (soda), sparkling water, canned veggies, soup, pet food, etc. There is a container in the fellowship hall where you can add them, which will be dropped off at the Ronald McDonald House @ Iowa Health Care on occasion. This helps to support their program of providing housing for parents whose children are undergoing medical treatment, so that parents can stay with their child and support them. If you have any questions, please ask Evelyn Thomas.

Mini Food Pantry

We will continue collecting and delivering items once a month for the food pantry in 2026. Please place your donations in the blue cloth bags under the stairway near the parking lot entrance to the church. Or you can take items to the pantry on your own. It is directly behind the library in a wooden shed. Shelves for cans, etc. are behind the left door. A refrigerator/freezer is behind the right door. Be sure to put nonfood items such as dish soap on the bottom shelf away from food items. Because it is available 24 hours a day, it is a convenient way to drop things off as you are in the area. Of course, we are happy to continue to deliver donations that you bring to the church.

FEBRUARY 2026 SCHEDULE OF WORSHIP HELPERS

February 1, 2026 4th Sunday after Epiphany
Musician: Anne Badger
Elder & Liturgist: Susie Smith
Ushers: Chuck Jones & Bonnie Cumberland
A/V: Angie & Dan Montague
Fellowship: Donuts – Toni & Phil Vella
Communion Preparer: Jim Rickert & Carol Shippert

February 8, 2026 5th Sunday after Epiphany
Musician: Crystal Kalebaugh-Green
Elder & Liturgist: Sarah Bingaman
Ushers:
A/V: Angie & Dan Montague
Fellowship Host: Susie Smith

February 15, 2026 Transfiguration of Our Lord
Musician: Carolyn McBride
Elder: Phil Vella & Liturgist: Toni Vella
Ushers:
A/V: Angie Montague & Phil Vella
Fellowship Host: Sheri Hill & Gayle Topping

February 18, 2026 Ash Wednesday Service 12:00 Noon
Musician: Crystal Kalebaugh-Green

February 22, 2026 1st Sunday in Lent
Musician: Crystal Kalebaugh-Green
Elder & Liturgist: Tom Cartwright
Ushers:
A/V: Angie Montague & Lance Schaefer
Fellowship Host: Badger Family

March 1, 2026 2nd Sunday in Lent
Musician:
Elder & Liturgist:
Ushers:
A/V:
Fellowship Host: Donuts -
Communion Preparer: Sheri Hill & Gayle Topping

If you would like to help with our Sunday tasks let Pastor or Lois know which one and they will connect you with that scheduler. Thank you!

February 2026 Birthdays & Anniversaries

Birthdays

02/04 Janette Rugh	02/08 Emily Dempsey
02/08 Charles Meyer	02/09 Lindsay Hoyle
02/14 Sue Coers	02/18 Linda Ebbens
02/19 Jane Landreth	02/20 Keith Rugh
02/21 Crystal Kalebaugh-Green	02/22 Elizabeth Presley
02/26 Sophia Wendt	

Anniversaries

02/14 Gene & Lesia Bothe



February 2026

Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
1 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour	2 6:00pm Quilters Meeting	3 12:30pm Worship Committee Meeting 3:30pm Mission/Witness Committee 4:30pm Finance & Property Committee	4	5 4:00pm Caregiver Support Meeting	6	7 9:00am St. Paul/Immanuel Council Meeting
8 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour	9 1:00pm PEO AC Meeting	10 9:30am Innermission Committee	11 5:00pm Christian Education Committee	12 5:30pm PEO Chapter KM Meeting	13	14 9:00am Session Retreat & Meeting
15 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour 11:00am NO Session Meeting	16 Presidents Day - Office closed 1:00pm PW Bible Study	17	18 Ash Wednesday Newsletter Deadline 12:00pm Ash Wednesday Service	19	20	21
22 First Sunday of Lent 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour 6:00pm Community Lenten Service- FPC Dixon	23	24	25	26	27	28



**First Presbyterian Church of Dixon
Sunday Service: 9:30 a.m.**

Find us on Facebook & YouTube.

www.fpcdixon.com

Pastor: Rev. Nikelle Johnson
Administrative Assistant: Lois Grimm
Custodian: Julie Glenn

Music Director: Kathleen Schaefer
A/V Tech: Carolyn McBride

OUR PURPOSE STATEMENT

As followers of Jesus Christ, we will, by our intentional actions,
seek a deeper relationship with God,
listen for the Spirit's call to mission in our community,
and prayerfully lead others to know the joy of God's love,
and to realize God's purpose for life's journey.

